

United States military deployments

The **military of the United States is deployed** in most countries around the world, with more than 160,000 of its active-duty personnel stationed outside the United States and its territories.^[1]

This list consists of deployments **excepting active combat deployments**, including troops in Iraq, Syria, Yemen, and Somalia.^[2]

Outside of active combat, US personnel are typically deployed as part of several peacekeeping and classified missions, military attachés, or are part of embassy and consulate security.

Rationale

Statements by U.S. military and government

A longstanding justification for maintaining military installations worldwide for the United States is that a military presence abroad by the U.S. promotes and strengthens democracy.^[3]

When asked about the reason behind U.S. military presence in Germany, former Supreme Allied Commander Europe Alexander Haig said that "the presence of U.S. troops keeps European markets open to us. If those troops weren't there, those markets would probably be more difficult to access."^[4] Adding, "On occasion, even with our presence, we have confronted protectionism in a number of industries, such as automotive and aerospace. In addition to economic benefits derived from our presence in Europe, there is perhaps an even more important diplomatic and political benefit."^[5]

Statements by others

According to Hermann and Kegley, military interventions have boosted democracy in other nations.^[6] The majority of academics,

however, concur with professor of international politics Abraham Lowenthal that American efforts to spread democracy have been "negligible, often counterproductive, and only occasionally positive."^{[6][7][8]}

JoAnn Chirico believes that, as of 2014, the U.S. military presence and installations are often considered responsible for suppressing democracy in countries such as Cameroon, Chad, Ethiopia, Jordan, Kuwait, Niger, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, and United Arab Emirates.^[3]

In her 1979 essay, "Dictatorships and Double Standards", Jeane Kirkpatrick argued that although the United States should encourage democracy, it should be understood that premature reforms may cause a backlash that could give the Communists an opportunity to take over. For this reason, she considered it legitimate to support non-communist dictatorships, adding that a successful and sustainable democratic process is likely to be a long-term process in many cases in the Third World. The essence of the so-called Kirkpatrick Doctrine is the use of selective methods to advance democracy in order to contain the wave of communism.^[9]

Current deployments

The following regional tables provide detail of where personnel from six branches of the US military are currently deployed. These

numbers do not include any military or civilian contractors or their dependents. Additionally, countries in which US military are engaged in active combat operations are not included. The numbers are based on the most recent United States Department of Defense statistics as of June 30, 2025.^[1]

Americas (Northern Command & Southern Command)

Jurisdiction	Total	<u>Army</u>	<u>Navy</u>	<u>USAF</u>	<u>USMC</u>
 <u>United States (contiguous)</u>	1,081,382	366,863	281,926	247,902	139,204
 <u>Alaska</u>	20,671	10,163	34	8,585	10
 <u>Puerto Rico</u>	774	117	34	24	12
 <u>Guantanamo Bay</u>	571	127	415	–	23
 <u>Honduras</u>	340	213	1	117	8
 <u>Canada</u>	157	25	38	74	12
 <u>Greenland</u>	142	–	–	116	–
other	718	152	147	69	290
Total	1,104,613	377,544	282,595	256,887	139,559

East Asia, Southeast Asia, and Pacific Ocean (Indo- Pacific Command)

Jurisdiction	Total	<u>Army</u>	<u>Navy</u>	<u>USAF</u>	<u>USMC</u>	<u>USCG</u>	<u>USSF</u>
 <u>Japan</u>	53,912	2,512	21,578	12,429	17,252	21	120
 <u>Hawaii</u>	45,445	19,236	12,399	5,323	6,756	1,556	175
 <u>South Korea</u>	23,766	15,015	360	8,152	167	1	7
 <u>Guam</u>	7,125	196	3,971	2,418	205	334	
 <u>Australia</u>	315	47	83	154	23	2	6
 <u>Singapore</u>	260	19	194	24	12	11	-
 <u>Diego Garcia</u>	230	-	230	-	-	-	-
other	462	137	67	57	188	13	-
Total	131,415	37,162	38,882	28,557	24,603	1,938	373

Europe (European Command)



US military bases in Germany in 2014

Jurisdiction	Total	<u>Army</u>	<u>Navy</u>	<u>USAF</u>	<u>USMC</u>	<u>USCG</u>	<u>USS</u>
 <u>Germany</u>	35,989	22,203	415	12,760	409	11	19
 <u>Italy</u>	12,571	4,112	3,531	4,847	58	1	2
 <u>United Kingdom</u>	10,071	217	274	9,457	52	14	5
 <u>Spain</u>	3,700	28	3,235	400	35	1	
 <u>Turkey</u>	1,717	122	6	1,559	30	–	–
 <u>Belgium</u>	1,122	606	92	389	32	–	–
 <u>Netherlands</u>	420	121	29	226	12	31	
 <u>Greece</u>	407	11	363	28	5	–	–
 <u>Poland</u>	342	208	93	31	10	–	–
 <u>Portugal</u>	236	5	45	170	15	1	–
 <u>Romania</u>	149	27	102	11	9	–	–
other	648	139	71	188	244	5	
Total	67,514	27,799	8,256	30,182	911	64	30

West Asia, Central Asia, South Asia, Africa, and Indian Ocean (Central Command)

Jurisdiction	Total	<u>Army</u>	<u>Navy</u>	<u>USAF</u>	<u>USMC</u>	<u>USCG</u>	<u>USS</u>
 <u>Bahrain</u>	3,391	23	2,818	19	197	334	
 <u>Kuwait</u>	559	529	3	18	9	–	
 <u>Saudi Arabia</u>	270	161	16	67	26	–	
 <u>Qatar</u>	254	118	6	107	7	–	
 <u>Egypt</u>	188	140	8	20	20	–	
 <u>United Arab Emirates</u>	129	26	21	35	47	–	
other	1,210	350	85	123	652	–	
Total	6,001	1,347	2,957	389	958	334	1

Unspecified

Jurisdiction	Total	<u>Army</u>	<u>Navy</u>	<u>USAF</u>	<u>USMC</u>	<u>USCG</u>	<u>USSE</u>
Overseas	9,715	4,308	12	1,188	4,170	–	37

See also

- List of notable deployments of U.S. military forces overseas since 1798

- List of United States overseas military bases
- List of United States military bases
- Marine Security Guard
- Military Assistance Advisory Group
- Military Assistance Command, Vietnam
- United States Taiwan Defense Command
- Status of forces agreement

- United States foreign aid
- United States militarism

References

1. *"Number of Military and DoD Appropriated Fund (APF) Civilian Personnel By Assigned Duty Location and Service/Component (as of June 30, 2025)" (<https://dwp.dmdc.osd.mil/dwp/api/downloadZ?fileId=138689&groupName=milReg>)*

*ionCountry) . Defense
Manpower Data Center.
August 18, 2025.*

*2. "Letter to the Speaker of
the House and President
Pro Tempore of the Senate
Regarding the War Powers
Report" (<https://bidenwhitehouse.archives.gov/briefing-room/statements-releases/2024/12/06/letter-to-the-speaker-of-the-house-and-president-pro-tempore-o>*

*f-the-senate-regarding-the
-war-powers-report-5/)* .
*White House. December 6,
2024.*

3. *Chirico 2014, p. 70.*

4. *"Text of UPI interview with
Haig - UPI.com" ([https://w
ww.upi.com/Defense-New
s/2002/01/07/Text-of-UPi-
interview-with-Haig/78831
010444063/](https://www.upi.com/Defense-News/2002/01/07/Text-of-UPi-interview-with-Haig/78831010444063/))* . *UPI.*
Retrieved January 30,

2026.

5. *"Text of UPI interview with Haig - UPI.com" (<https://www.upi.com/Defense-News/2002/01/07/Text-of-UPi-interview-with-Haig/78831010444063/>) . UPI. Retrieved January 30, 2026.*

6. *Hermann, Margaret G.; Kegley, Charles (1998). "The U.S. Use of Military*

*Intervention to Promote Democracy: Evaluating the Record". International Interactions. **24** (2): 91–114.*

doi:10.1080/03050629808434922 (<https://doi.org/10.1080/03050629808434922>) .

7. Lowenthal, Abraham (1991). The United States and Latin American Democracy: Learning from

History. Baltimore: Johns Hopkins University Press. pp. 243–65.

8. *Peceny, Mark (1999).*

Democracy at the Point of Bayonets (<https://archive.org/details/democracyatpoint00pece>). University Park: Pennsylvania State University Press. p. 183 (<https://archive.org/details/democracyatpoint00pece/page/n191>) . ISBN 0-271-

01883-6.

9. *Wright 2007, p. 29.*

- Chirico, JoAnn (2014).

Globalization: Prospects and Problems (<https://books.google.com/books?id=ZawgAQAAQBAJ&dq=%22support+of+dictators%22&pg=PA71>). SAGE Publication Ltd. p. 71.
ISBN 9781483315447.

- Wright, Steven (2007). *The United States and Persian*

Gulf Security. Ithaca Press.
ISBN 978-0-86372-321-6.

Further reading

- "America's Forever wars" (<https://www.nytimes.com/2017/10/22/opinion/americas-forever-wars.html>). *New York Times*.
October 23, 2017.
- Machain, Carla Martinez; Allen, Michael A.; Flynn, Michael E.
(December 2, 2019). "Why does the US pay so much for

the defense of its allies? 5 questions answered" (<https://theconversation.com/why-does-the-us-pay-so-much-for-the-defense-of-its-allies-5-questions-answered-127683>).⁴

The Conversation. Retrieved July 28, 2021.

- Allen, Michael A; Flynn, Michael E; Martinez Machain, Carla (2021). "US global military deployments, 1950–2020*" (<https://doi.org/10.117>

7/07388942211030885).⁸.

*Conflict Management and
Peace Science*. **39** (3): 351–
370.

doi:10.1177/07388942211030
885 (https://doi.org/10.1177%
2F07388942211030885).⁴.

ISSN 0738-8942 (https://sear
ch.worldcat.org/issn/0738-89
42).⁴. S2CID 237722626 (http
s://api.semanticscholar.org/Cor
pusID:237722626).⁴.

- Base Structure Report – Fiscal

Year 2023 Baseline (<https://www.acq.osd.mil/eie/Downloads/BSI/Base%20Structure%20Report%20FY23.xlsx>).[↗] (XLS)
(Report). U.S. Department of
Defense.

Retrieved from

"https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=United_States_military_deployments&oldid=1356774521"



This page was last edited on 29 May 2026, at 19:07 (UTC). •

Page was rendered with [Parsoid](#). •

Content is available under [CC BY-SA 4.0](#)  unless otherwise noted.